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WORLD • ASIA

China Economic Activity Loses Steam Sharply in October

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China's economic activity slowed sharply in October, with gauges of manufacturing, services and construction all pointing to a loss of momentum.

The official manufacturing purchasing managers index fell to 49.3 in October, down from 50.1 in September, said the National Bureau of Statistics on Saturday.

The result undershot the 49.8 forecast made by economists in a Wall Street Journal survey and dropped into contraction territory again after a short rebound into expansion. A reading above the 50 mark suggests activity expansion, while below that threshold means a contraction.

The production subindex fell to 49.8 in October, down from 51.7 in September. The subindex for total new orders dropped to 49.4, compared with September's 50.5 while new export orders declined to 48.7 from to 50.0 in September.

Meanwhile, China's nonmanufacturing PMI, which covers both service and construction activity, declined to 49.7 in October, compared with 50.2 in September, the statistics bureau said.

The subindex tracking service activity fell to 50.0 in October, down from 50.2 in September, while the construction subindex dropped to 48.0 from 50.3 in September.

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